

United States History and Geography — Student Form

United States History and Geography · Tennessee Academic Standards 2027-28 · Form FORM-B

classroom-formative · pre-field-test. Item parameters are estimates and have not met a student; this form is not a calibrated instrument. This form assesses Depth of Knowledge levels 1 through 4.

1. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows the signing ceremony for the North Atlantic Treaty on April 4, 1949. The treaty created the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO), a mutual defense alliance between the United States, Canada, and ten Western European nations. (Photograph, April 4, 1949. Public Domain.) What was the **PRIMARY** purpose of the alliance created by the treaty shown being signed in this photograph?

- A.** To establish free trade among Western nations
- B.** To create a unified European government
- C.** To dismantle colonial empires in Asia and Africa
- D.** To provide collective defense against Soviet aggression in Europe

2. What was the satellite state system in Eastern Europe?

- A.** Eastern European countries controlled by the Soviet Union after World War II
- B.** Independent nations that voluntarily formed economic partnerships with the USSR
- C.** Asian countries that cooperated on space technology with the Soviet program
- D.** Western European nations that received economic aid from the United States

3. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows the NATO treaty signing, April 4, 1949. (Photograph, 1949. Public Domain.) How did the creation of NATO, shown in this photograph, represent a departure from traditional American foreign policy?

- A.** NATO was a temporary agreement that expired after five years
- B.** It was the first peacetime military alliance in American history
- C.** The alliance required no military commitment from the United States
- D.** The United States had long maintained peacetime military alliances in Europe

4. How did the formation of NATO and the Warsaw Pact reflect the ideological competition between the United States and the Soviet Union during the Cold War?

- A.** The alliances reflected agreement between superpowers on the need for collective disarmament
- B.** Both alliances were formed primarily for economic cooperation rather than military defense
- C.** They split Europe into rival military blocs, one capitalist and one communist
- D.** NATO and the Warsaw Pact were created jointly to prevent a third world war between smaller nations

5. The Cold War was fought through proxies, propaganda, espionage, and economic competition rather than direct military conflict between the U.S. and Soviet Union. Analyze WHY the Cold War took this form by examining at least THREE factors that prevented direct conflict. Then evaluate whether this "cold" form of warfare was more or less dangerous than traditional warfare.

6. DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION: The Marshall Plan — Economic Aid as Cold War Strategy Directions: Read the following two primary source excerpts and then respond to the prompt below. Analyze both documents using the SOAPS framework (Speaker, Occasion, Audience, Purpose, Significance) and construct an evidence-based argument. --- DOCUMENT A: Secretary of State George C. Marshall, Commencement Address at Harvard University, June 5, 1947 — U.S. government document, available through the Avalon Project, Yale Law School: "It is logical that the United States should do whatever it is able to do to assist in the return of normal economic health in the world, without which there can be no political stability and no assured peace. Our policy is directed not against any country or doctrine but against hunger, poverty, desperation, and chaos. Any government that is willing to assist in the task of recovery will find full co-operation... on the part of the United States Government. Any government which maneuvers to block the recovery of other countries cannot expect help from us." DOCUMENT B: Soviet Foreign Minister Vyacheslav Molotov, Statement rejecting the Marshall Plan, Paris Conference, July 2, 1947 — diplomatic record, available through the Avalon Project, Yale Law School: "The American plan splits Europe into two groups of states and creates new difficulties in the relations between them... The Marshall plan, which envisages for American credits various conditions infringing on the sovereignty of European countries and interfering in their home affairs... will lead to nothing but a further aggravation of relations between countries." --- Using both documents and your knowledge of Cold War economic competition (US.61, US.59), construct an argument that evaluates the Marshall Plan as a Cold War strategic instrument. Apply SOAPS analysis to both documents and address: (1) whether Marshall's stated humanitarian purpose was consistent with the Plan's actual geopolitical effects; (2) why the Soviet Union rejected the Plan and whether that rejection was strategically rational; and (3) what the exchange between these two documents reveals about the fundamental incompatibility that defined the early Cold War.